



English Highway Podcast

Pronunciation: The short /a/ (#0258)

Use common vocabulary words and phrases to learn the short /a/ sound.



Announcer:

You're about to listen to an audio lesson from OpenEnglish.com.

Welcome. My name is Andres Moreno, and I'll be your English coach for this lesson. Our goal with these audio lessons is to help you improve your listening and speaking skills by working on key pronunciation tools.

Today, we're going to practice listening for the sound of the short "a" vowel, like in the word "bat." Listen to me. "Bat." "Bat."

The sound is "aaa" "aaa" "bat."

The short "a" vowel is one of the most common sounds in the English language. Let's practice by saying a few words and phrases. Repeat after me:

"bat"

"bat"

Good job. Again:

"bat"

"bat"

Way to go!

If someone asks you, "Are you a student?"

You can answer, "Yes, I am."

So repeat after me:

"Yes, I am."

Once again:

"Yes, I am."

Great job. Can you guess which word has the short "a" sound?

That's right, "am."

Repeat after me:

"am"

That's it. Here's another common expression. Repeat after me:

"Good afternoon!"

Once again:

"Good afternoon!"

The word afternoon contains the short "a" sound, "afternoon." Repeat after me:

"afternoon"

"Good afternoon."

Great job. Let's try another sentence. Listen and then repeat after me:

"I am a student in Los Angeles."

"I am."

"Los Angeles"

Both "am" and "Los Angeles" contain the short "a" sound. So repeat after me:

"I am"

"Los Angeles"

Now the whole sentence:

"I am a student in Los Angeles."

That's it. Let's keep practicing. But hey, wait a minute. The word "practice" also has the short "a" sound. Repeat after me:

"practice"

"practice"

Can you hear the short "a" sound?

"practice"

That's it. Congratulations. Now let's practice some of the most common words with the short "a" sound. Repeat after me:

"cab"

Come on, stretch the sound:

"aaa"

"cab"

One more time:

"cab"

You got it. Here's another common word. Repeat after me:

"tab"

Come on, again:

"tab"

Put some energy into it:

"tab"

That's it. Let's keep practicing. Here's another common word. Repeat after me:

"bad"

And again:

"bad"

Way to go. Here's another one. Repeat after me:

"dad"

Come on, you can do it:

"dad"

We're going to keep practicing til this sound is easy to say. Here's another word. Repeat after me:

"had"

And again, come on:

"had"

One more time:

"had"

Way to go. We have five more words to practice, so let's keep at it. Repeat after me:

"mad"

"mad"

You can say:

"I am mad."

Once again:

"I am mad."

Good job. Here's the next word:

"sad"

And again:

"sad"

Here's another word. Repeat after me:

"bag"

The key is to stretch the sound, come on:

"bag"

Good job. You're doing great. Let's keep practicing. Repeat after me once again:

"ham"

"ham"

"at"

"map"

"man"

"fan"

Way to go. As you can see, the short "a" sound is very common in English. Let's practice a few short sentences with these words. Repeat after me:

"Please call a cab."

"Please call a cab."

"He is my dad."

"He is my dad."

"Pass me the map."

Again! Come on, you can do it:

"Pass me the map."

Last time, come on:

"Pass me the map."

Way to go. That's the end of this audio lesson. Thank you for your time and effort. My recommendation is for you to listen to this lesson as many

times as you can because remember, practice makes perfect!
For additional practice, turn on your computer and go to
OpenEnglish.com. At OpenEnglish, you'll find hundreds of interactive
lessons and videos to help you perfect your English.
Accelerate your English today. See you soon.

Additional practice: Emphasizing key words

Words:

bat
am
afternoon
Los Angeles
practice
cab
tab
bad
dad
had
mad
sad
bag
ham
at
map
man
fan

Sentences:

"Yes, I am."
"Good afternoon!"
"I am a student in Los Angeles."
"I am mad."
"Please call a cab."
"He is my dad."
"Pass me the map."